

What do you know about the Evolution of Islamic Historiography?

Islamic historiography has undergone a significant evolution since the early days of Islam. Over the centuries, various Muslim historians have contributed to the development of this field, each adding their own perspectives and interpretations of events. The genealogical study of pre-Islamic Arabs and the description of their 'Battle-Days' had their share in imparting knowledge through the technique of narration, not very definite ideas about history. The notion of pride among Pre-Islamic tribes is exhibited in their description through the vehicle of poetry, that was operative even among the Umayyads. One of them, Abid bin Shariyya, was summoned by Muawiyah, the founder of the Umayyad Caliphate, to relate the history of the Kings of Yaman. Abid bin Shariyya composed a book of kings and past history which was very much in demand in the first century of Islam. Early period of Islamic historiography focused on oral traditions, and the collection and preservation of Hadith and Sirah (biographies of the Prophet Muhammad). Some of the most famous early Muslim historians include Abdullah ibn al-Zubayr, Urwah ibn al-Zubayr, and Aisha bint Abu Bakr.

During the classical period, Islamic historiography saw a growth in writings of more structured and comprehensive histories, often with a political or ideological agenda. Some of the most prominent classic Muslim historians from this period include Ibn Ishaq, Ibn Hisham, Al-Waqidi, Ibn Sad, Ibn Qutaiba, Al-Baladhuri, Al-Masudi, Al-Tabari, Ibn Khaldun etc. Ibn Hisham, Ibn Ishaq, Al-Waqidi, Ibn Qutaiba etc. represent the classical period where the collection of information was the chief motivation. Later, Al-Masudi, Al-Tabari, Ibn Khaldun brought about the golden age where the socio-economic perspectives got included gradually.

Write Notes on- Ibn Hisham, Ibn Qutaiba and Tabari

Ibn Hisham : Abdul Malek bin Hisham was born in Basra and died in Egypt. According to Khuda Bakhsh, Ibn Hisham shows a distinct advance upon Ibn Ishaq in the handling of his materials. He reveals greater critical insight, shows an inclination to test the sources of his information and expresses his opinion on their authenticity or otherwise.

Ibn Qutaiba: Ibn Qutaiba wrote Kitab al-Maarif. The book begins with the creation and the author cites Biblical passages referring to it and the creation of man and his fall, Then follows the history of the patriarchs according to biblical and Arab legends. The old traditional view is discarded and replaced by a wider intellectual vision. The history of the Prophet forms now only a part of the whole work and non Muslim nations are also given attention. He studied history from a different angle, and his work inspired the next generation of historians not to analyse history from a religious viewpoint only .

Al-Tabari: Tabari and Masudi brought about the golden age of Islamic Historiography. His exhaustive commentary on the Quran and his chronology of Apostles and Kings, entitled Kitab al Muluk-wa-Rasul, brought down to 298 A.H. Tabari acquired eminence in Tradition, Law, reading of the Quran and history. According to Margoliouth, Tabari is the first great Muslim historian who dealt with the subject in the comprehensive and annalistic method and he formed a chronological sense of events. Tabari has dealt with the history of pre Islamic period in two volumes and he has dwelt upon the life of the Prophet, the Caliphs, the Umayyad and the Abbasid dynasty up to 302 A.H/915 A.D.

In order to Maintain Friendly Relations with the Jews, what did the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) do?

The Jews of Madinah initially joined the Muslims in welcoming Muhammad (S.M). The Prophet. They acknowledged the divine authority of our religion, and had even rested the prophet's claim upon the evidence of their Scriptures. As monotheists and as the Prophet called them "People of the book", Prophet Muhammad(PBUH) sought to create strong alliances with the Jews. A sub-portion of Jews even accepted him as the awaited one, the Messiah, but this was rejected by the overall majority. To maintain friendly relations with the Jew, Prophet Muhammad(PBUH) took many significant steps. They include:

1. Protecting their rights: The Prophet established a treaty with the Jews in Medina known as the Constitution of Medina, which guaranteed their rights and protection as a religious minority.

2. Encouraging mutual respect: The Prophet encouraged mutual respect and cooperation between Jews and Muslims and encouraged both communities to live together in peace.

3. Avoiding conflict: The Prophet sought to avoid conflict with the Jews and, when conflicts did arise, he made efforts to resolve them peacefully.

4. Allowing religious freedom: The Prophet allowed Jews to practise their religion freely and did not interfere with their religious practices.

5. Promoting economic cooperation: The Prophet encouraged economic cooperation between Jews and Muslims, allowing both communities to prosper and thrive.

The prophet also adopted some of their religious practices for a brief period of time. One of them was facing the Qibla. Before the verse "The block-headed will say: "What has turned them away from the direction they formerly observed in Prayer? Say: "To Allah belong the East and the West; He guides whomsoever He wills onto a Straight Way.", Muslims faced the qibla at Jerusalem, a custom practised in Jewish communities. But after these revelations, the qibla changed toward Kaba . Prophet Muhammad(PBUH)

honoured the other prophets before him who were mentioned in the Jewish book, because they were also part of Islam, such as Abraham, Ishaq, Joseph, Ishmael, Moses etc. Throughout his life, the prophet emphasised the importance of respecting and protecting the rights of religious minorities and promoting mutual respect and understanding between different communities.

Draw the Significance of Social Cultures in your Eye.

Culture is a vital aspect of society, as they shape our beliefs, behaviours, and values. These cultures provide a framework for social interaction, which helps people understand and interpret the world around them. Social cultures also create a sense of belonging and identity, as individuals often identify themselves based on their culture. One of the essential aspects of social cultures is language. Language is critical for communication, and it lets us interact with people and express our thoughts and feelings. Social cultures also play a significant role in shaping the way people perceive and interact with the world, including their attitudes towards social issues such as gender roles, race, and religion. It is also essential in preserving traditions and cultural practices, which can help communities maintain a sense of continuity and connectedness. They provide people with a sense of history and help them connect with their ancestors, strengthening their identity and sense of belonging. Furthermore, social cultures contribute to the diversity and richness of the human experience. They offer different perspectives and ways of living, which can help broaden people's minds and foster a greater appreciation for other cultures.

What are the teachings of Farewell sermon of the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)?

[The Last Sermon Of Prophet Muhammad\(SAW\)\(just read this a couple times man\)](#)

On the 9th of Zil-Hajj, 10 AH, the Prophet gave his last sermon. The speech which he delivered on this occasion is still fresh in the memory of every Muslim. This sermon was historically significant for multiple reasons which include:

1. Brotherhood : Rasulullah's (PBUH) farewell speech binds all Muslims to a strong bond of brotherhood, and ensures security, including the safety of life, dignity and property of all. Holy Apostle (PBUH) provisioned it as a final point of the essentials of human life- Declaration of universal Human rights, removing racism, trampling the ignorance of the people of jahiliyyah, removing bloodshed and riba.

2. Human Rights: The prophet established that every man came from Adam and Hawwa and were equal, and that no man will ever be above another except by piety and good actions .

3.Faithfulness: The holy Prophet (PBUH) reminded the present gathering that they will be accountable to Allah for what they have done in life; and he emphasised following perfectly the path shown by him. In the address, all believers were warned that no one could save them from going astray unless they adhered to the Qur'an and the Sunnah. Particularly the sermon urges believers to build a

society based on justice, free from exploitation and discrimination, irrespective of class, caste and religion.

4. Universality : Though the instructions of the sermon are directed to the believers, they are equally applicable for every country and nation in the world; because these principles can make any country or nation peaceful and prosperous, based on unity, equality and brotherhood. Thus the farewell sermon is eternal and universal - it still calls on all humanity today to build peaceful law and order, social security, sustainable and justified human rights, a better life and a better society.

The address is not only incredible for its eloquence but also its glorious and sublime message to humankind on the earth. No better principles have been set in any other speech in the world than the Farewell sermon on ethics. Every sentence breathes a sense of greatness and establishes righteous and fair dealing among humanity on a workable basis. This sermon consolidates the unity of ummah, establishes all types of Muslims of the world into one brotherhood, It touches the end by determining a social system that is completely free from all forms of exploitation and injustice. In the context of knitting such artistic slides, it can be said the farewell sermon of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) holds its position as the world's most incredible speech forever.

Evaluate 'Ibn Khaldun' as a Historian.

Ibn Khaldun was an Arab sociologist, philosopher, and historian, widely acknowledged to be one of the greatest social scientists of the Middle Ages, who made major contributions in the areas of historiography, sociology, economics, and demography. De boer says "Ibn Khaldun is the first who tried to explain fully the evolution and progress of society, its causes and factors, and their effects on the formation of man's mind and sentiment as well as the formation of society."

Ibn Khaldun is trying to present a sociological theory through his book *Al Muqaddimah* where he is concerned with widespread strong collective belief and faith that would enable us to understand the society among the Bedouins of the Arab, who used to spend the majority of their time in the desert. Bloodlines and purity of lineage were some of the key characteristics of the Bedouins, due to which, there was an increased sense of solidarity between them. The fundamental characteristic of his theory is the concept of "Al-asabiyyah" or group feeling. Although it was a familiar term in pre-Islamic era, it was Ibn Khaldun's *Muqaddimah* which made it popular, where it is described as a fundamental bond of humankind. Ibn Khaldun, De Boer observes. "comes forward with a claim to establish a new philosophical discipline of which Aristotle had no conception". The historical works of his forerunners, particularly of Tabari and Masudi, have had the most influence on the development of his thoughts. According to Walter J. Fischel, the historian Tabari is regarded by Ibn Khaldun as one of the few good historians, and counted among those historians of whom there are "not more than the fingers on one hand". In his work, Fischel described Ibn Khaldun as a highly original and creative historian who had a profound influence on the development of Islamic historiography. According to Fischel, Ibn Khaldun's most important contribution to the field was his innovative method of historical analysis, which was based

on a systematic study of the causes of political and social change. He also praised Ibn Khaldun's philosophical insights and his ability to draw connections between events and phenomena in a way that was both comprehensive and insightful. Ibn Khaldun leans heavily on Tabari's historical works and draws material from him for his history of the non-arab peoples and for the illustration of his own socio-philosophical views. Masudi discarded the old school of historiography which followed closely on the traditional method and conceived of a new style and technique of history writing which took cognizance of society and social aspects of human life. This particular standpoint was fully developed by Ibn Khaldun and he made a scientific and analytic study of history, which established history as a science which teaches us that it is not a mere catalogue of facts, nor a mere narrative of past happenings, but a science to be studied for understanding the causes of the rise and fall of States and nations. It is Ibn Khaldun's Muqaddimah (prolegomena) which forms his social and political philosophy'. Writing of history requires numerous sources of information and varied knowledge. The historian, Ibn Khaldun says, should try to grasp the truth and be careful of slips and errors. If he trusts his information or data and does not try to ascertain the truth or authenticity thereof by means of laws governing historical development and by comparing with nearer and contemporary events, he is often liable to deviate from the truth. His works remain an important source of knowledge and insight into the history and culture of the Islamic world.

What is the Significance of Baitul Hikmah in Spreading Knowledge?

The House of Wisdom (Bayt Al-Hikmah) was seen as one of the leading libraries in Islamic history that appeared during the Golden age of Islam. It was initiated by the Abbasid dynasty. The House Of Wisdom had a crucial role to play in linking the Islamic world fronts in east and west and in introducing our heritage in its perfect form to all Muslims in order to preserve it from loss and deterioration. As a result, the library had gained a great fame in the Islamic world for it was the first scientific and educational library that assembled scientists, scholars and translators to study and research. The house of wisdom became an exemplary model for other Caliphs and princes, who simulated and founded new libraries and houses of wisdom that could compete with the one in Baghdad. This contest attained intellectual and scientific advancements in every sphere in the Islamic world. The libraries that flourished following the example of the house of wisdom had their doors open to scholars from all over the world. The house of wisdom was a centre of knowledge and education, it was a rival of the Constantinople, if it did not exceed it. It was the model for other libraries and similar institutions throughout Islamic civilization. The example of the house of wisdom was remarkably followed and its influence appeared when other many public libraries emerged all the way from Bokhara and Merv, in the heart of Asia, on the route to China through Basra and Damascus, Algiers and Cairo. The famous geographer Yaqut al Hamawi who had visited Merv in the late 1220s, found more than twelve libraries there open to the public. And they functioned the same as the house of wisdom in Baghdad. Ten libraries were through endowments (awqaf). He interestingly expressed his admiration for the lending policies of the libraries there, he noted that libraries in Merv lent him more than 200 volumes he could use in his

room at the same time. Employees in the House of Wisdom in Baghdad were people of higher intellectual abilities, the same was emulated in every public library across the Muslim world. They often had a staff list that reached hundreds of copyists, illuminators, binders, translators, and authors. Those whom we can consider librarians were not randomly chosen but they usually were scholars, poets, multilinguals and writers who on the other side were well paid by caliphs, rulers or nobles. Many of the Islamic libraries also contained rooms for meetings and other rooms for discussions and debating. The Muslim libraries have played a major role in translating and transmitting works of Greek, Persian, Indian and Assyrian physicians and philosophers, works that later became the basic textbooks in European schools of Bologna, Naples and Paris. It is likely that without the Muslim libraries, modern Europe's scientific and intellectual progress would have been remarkably inhibited.

Write Notes on- Jaber Ibn Hayyan, Ibn Sina, Muhammad Ibn Musa alKhwarizmi.

Jaber Ibn Hayyan - The Persian pioneer is considered the most important alchemist in history. He established the principles of modern chemistry when he introduced the scientific method to alchemy. Through laboratory experimentation unheard of at his time, Hayyan developed and described the chemical processes of crystallisation, distillation and the basic substances that became the foundation of modern chemistry, such as acetic acid, mercury and sulphur.

Ibn Sina - Ibn Sina, was a polymath who is regarded as one of the most significant physicians, astronomers, philosophers, and writers of the Islamic Golden Age, and the father of early modern medicine. Sajjad H. Rizvi has called Avicenna "arguably the most influential philosopher of the pre-modern era". He was a Muslim Peripatetic philosopher influenced by Greek Aristotelian philosophy. Of the 450 works he is believed to have written, around 240 have survived, including 150 on philosophy and 40 on medicine. His most famous works are The Book of Healing, a philosophical and scientific encyclopaedia, and The Canon of Medicine, a medical

encyclopaedia which became a standard medical text at many mediaeval universities and remained in use as late as 1650. Ibn Sina's corpus includes writings on astronomy, alchemy, geography, geology, psychology, Islamic theology, logic, mathematics, physics, and works of poetry.

Muhammad Ibn Musa al-Khwarizmi : Muḥammad ibn Mūsā al-Khwārizmī or al-Khwarizmi, was a Persian polymath from Khwarazm, who produced vastly influential works in mathematics, astronomy, and geography. Around 820 CE, he was appointed as the astronomer and head of the library of the House of Wisdom in Baghdad. Al-Khwarizmi's popularising treatise on algebra presented the first systematic solution of linear and quadratic equations. One of his principal achievements in algebra was his demonstration of how to solve quadratic equations by completing the square, for which he provided geometric justifications. Because he was the first to treat algebra as an independent discipline and introduced the methods of "reduction" and "balancing", he has been described as the father or founder of algebra. The term algebra itself comes from the title of his book *Ḥisāb al-Jabr wal-Muqābalah* (the word al-jabr meaning "completion" or "rejoining"). His name gave rise to the terms algorism and algorithm, chief terms in today's mathematics and computer science

Evaluate the Contributions of Muslim Scientists in different fields of Knowledge.

Muslim scientists have made significant contributions to various fields of knowledge throughout history. Some of the most notable contributions include:

Mathematics: Muslim scholars introduced Arabic numerals and the concept of zero to the world.. The Persian mathematician Al-Khwarizmi is considered the father of algebra, and his book "Al-Jabr" laid the foundation for modern algebraic equations.

Astronomy: the development of celestial maps, the discovery of new stars and planets, and the determination of the earth's circumference. The Persian astronomer Al-Battani is credited with determining the length of the year to within seconds.

Physics: Ḥasan Ibn al-Haytham made significant contributions to the principles of optics and visual perception in particular. His most influential work is titled Kitāb al-Manāẓir. He is referred to as "the father of modern optics"

Medicine: The development of surgical instruments and the establishment of hospitals. The Persian physician Ibn Sina, also known as Avicenna, wrote the "Canon of Medicine," which became a standard medical text in Europe for centuries.

Philosophy: The development of logical reasoning and the integration of Greek philosophy with Islamic theology. The Persian philosopher Al-Farabi is credited with developing the concept of the "ideal state" and the classification of sciences.

Chemistry: Ibn Hayyan is known for advances he made in areas such as refining metals, fabricating and using dyes and inks, and contributions to glassmaking. The development of the distillation process and the discovery of new chemical compounds. The Persian chemist AlRazi, also known as Rhazes, wrote several books on chemistry and medicine, including "Kitab alAsrar" (The Book of Secrets).

Architecture: Muslim architects made significant contributions to architecture, including the development of the pointed arch and the use of geometric patterns in design. The Persian architect, mathematician, and poet Omar Khayyam is known for his work on the design of buildings, as well as his contributions to mathematics and literature.

What are the Branches of Islamic knowledge in your Eye?

Islamic knowledge encompasses a wide range of subjects related to the religion of Islam, its teachings, and its practices. Some of the traditional branches of Islamic knowledge include:

Quranic studies: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Quran, its interpretation, and its application in everyday life.

Hadith studies: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the

Prophet Muhammad's sayings, actions, and teachings.

Fiqh (Islamic jurisprudence): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic law, including its principles, sources, and application in various areas of life, such as worship, family, business, and politics.

Aqeedah (Islamic theology): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic beliefs, including the existence of Allah, the Prophets, and the Hereafter.

Tafsir (Quranic exegesis): This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Quranic commentary, including its language, style, and meaning.

Sufism (Islamic mysticism): This branch of Islamic knowledge deals with the study of Islamic spirituality, including practices such as meditation, remembrance of Allah, and detachment from worldly pleasures.

Arabic language: This branch of Islamic knowledge focuses on the study of the Arabic language, including its grammar, syntax, and vocabulary, which are essential for understanding the Quran and other Islamic texts.

There are also other branches of Islamic knowledge, such as **Islamic history**, **Islamic economics**, and **Islamic art and architecture** that are related to different aspects of Islamic civilization and culture

Distinguish between the main beliefs of Islam and Christianity

According to the Quran, current Christianity is the corrupted form of the religion taught by The prophet Isa(AS) and thus they share many similarities, but also dissimilarities as well.

Here are some key differences between their main beliefs::

Belief in God: Both religions believe in one God. In Islam, God is referred to as Allah, and there is no other God but Allah. In short, the concept of Tawheed or

oneness of God permeates Islam. In Christianity, God is referred to as the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, who are distinct but equal, also called The Holy Trinity.

Belief in The Last Prophets: Both religions believe in the existence of prophets. But differ in the acceptance of the last prophet. Muslims consider Prophet Muhammad(PBUH) as the final prophet. But Christians consider Jesus as the final prophet, also consider him divine, speaking of him as Lord and Saviour.

Belief in the Afterlife: Both religions believe in the afterlife and judgement day, but the concepts differ. Muslims believe in the Day of Judgment, where people will be judged according to their deeds, and their final destination will be either Paradise or Hell. Christians believe in the final judgement, where people will be judged based on their faith in Jesus Christ, and their final destination will be either Heaven or Hell.

Belief in the Holy Scriptures: Muslims believe in the Quran as the holy book, which is considered to be the final and complete revelation of God to humanity through Prophet Muhammad. Christians believe in the Bible, which consists of the Old and New Testaments, and believe it to be the inspired word of God.

Belief in Salvation: Both religions have different views on how a person can achieve salvation. Muslims believe that one must believe in one God, perform good deeds, and follow the Five Pillars of Islam, which are Shahada (declaration of faith), Salah (prayer), Zakat (charity), Sawm (fasting), and Hajj (pilgrimage to Mecca). Christians believe that salvation comes through faith in Jesus Christ and his death and resurrection, and that good works are a result of faith, not a means to achieve it.

In summary, while both religions have some common beliefs, such as the belief in one God, the belief in the afterlife, and the belief in prophets, they differ in many aspects, including their beliefs in salvation, holy scriptures, and the concept of God